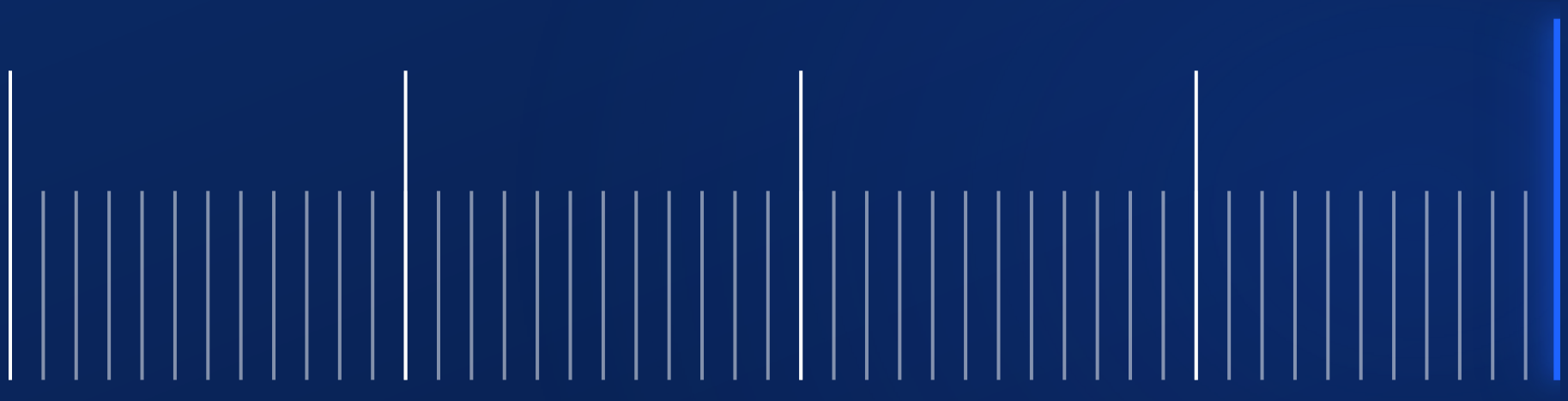
What 48 months of search demand says about SEO

3,751 keywords, June 2022 to May 2026



Rankability

SEO-related demand fell 30% from its 2025 peak

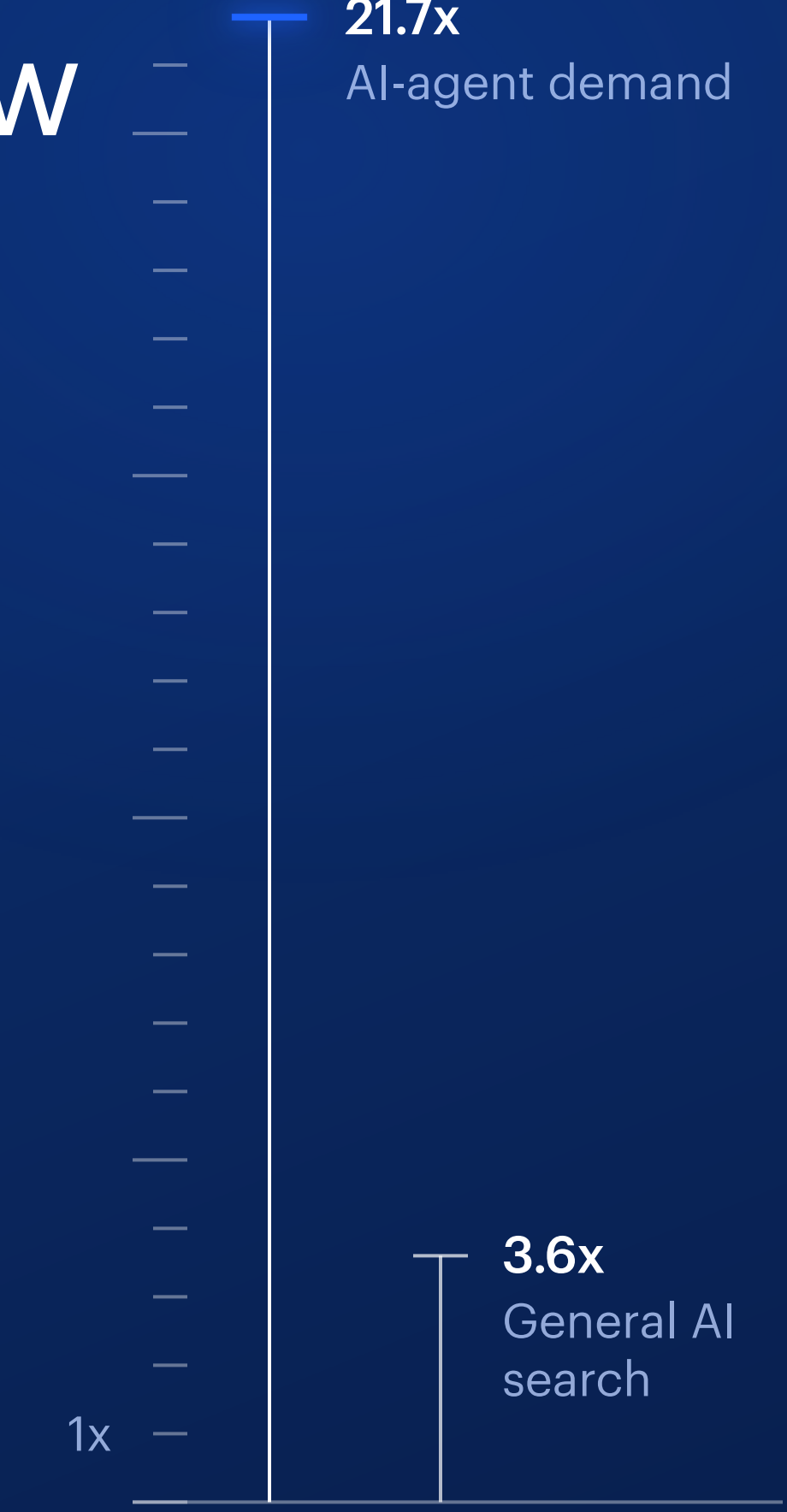
The first sustained decline in the four years we measured



Source: Rankability, 3,751 keywords, June 2022 to May 2026. rankability.com

AI-agent demand grew 21.7x in three years

General AI search demand grew 3.6x over the same three years



Source: Rankability, 3,751 keywords, May 2023 to May 2026. rankability.com

Rankability



Source: Rankability, 3,751 keywords,
June 2022 to May 2026. rankability.com

GEO drew about 2.2x the demand of AEO

Both started near zero in 2023 and leveled off in early 2026

What this doesn’t show

Search demand is interest, not adoption.

Keyword Planner values are bucketed, so read these as trends.

Both terms are still small next to SEO.

Decide what you'll call this work

Agree on the name, the scope and the report before a client asks.

Read the 7 predictions for 2027. →